

Benjamin J. Zubaly

Department of Psychology, University of Michigan

[bbzubaly@umich.edu](mailto:bzubaly@umich.edu) | [Personal Website](#)

Citizenship: USA

Updated June 1, 2026

EDUCATION

University of Michigan 2031 (expected)

Ph.D. in Social Psychology

Primary Advisor: Josh Ackerman

Secondary Advisor: Shinobu Kitayama

Trinity Western University 2024

B.A. (Honours) in Psychology with Great Distinction

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social psychology, evolutionary psychology, cultural evolution

PAPERS

Arbeau, K., Steeves, K., **Zubaly, B.**, Thorpe, C., & Todd, H. (2026). Drawings of the Self During COVID-19 Reveal Lived Experiences of the Pandemic. *Journal of Medical Humanities*.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10912-026-10021-w>

[‡]Acem, E., Aczel, B., Albayrak-Aydemir, N., Brown, N., Dudda, L., Elsherif, M., Gjoneska, B., Kowal, M., Krishna, A., Miłkoś, S., Paruzel-Czachura, M., Patel, J., Pypno-Blajda, K., Scharlau, I., Verheyen, S., **Zubaly, B.** (2025). Why I declare a conflict of interest and you should not. *Theory and Society*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11186-025-09641-3>

Palmer-Hague, J., Stobbart, J., **Zubaly, B.** (2025). Women's intrasexual competitiveness, but not fertility, predicts greater competitive behavior toward attractive women across the menstrual cycle. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 46(6), 106760.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evolhumbehav.2025.106760>

Zubaly, B., Arbeau, K., & Palmer-Hague, J. (2025). Sociosexual attitudes mediate the relationship between behavioral immune system reactivity and religiosity. *Evolutionary Behavioral Sciences*.
<https://doi.org/10.1037/ebs0000388>

Zubaly, B., Palmer-Hague, J. (2025). Fathers' facial dominance predicts first-born sons in parent dyads. *Adaptive Human Behavior and Physiology*, 11(1), 1. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40750-024-00254-1>

[‡] Indicates equal authorship contributions.

FUNDING

2026	Brickman Summer Research Prize, Social Psychology, University of Michigan (\$2,000)
2026	EHAP Research Award, Evolution and Human Adaptation Program (\$1,000)
2026	Rackham Conference Travel Grant, Rackham Graduate School (\$900)
2024	Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA), Trinity Western University (\$10,500)
2022	Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA), Trinity Western University (\$10,500)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Zubaly, B.**, Palmer-Hague, J., Stobbart, J. (2026). Women's intrasexual competitiveness, but not fertility, predicts greater competitive behavior toward attractive women across the menstrual cycle. *Poster presented at SPSP in Chicago, IL.*
- Arbeau, K., Thorpe, C., **Zubaly, B.**, Steeves, K. (2025). Drawing of the self during COVID-19 reveal lived experiences of the pandemic. *Poster presented at the 86th Annual Canadian Psychological Association (CPA) National Convention in St. Johns, NL by KA.*
- Zubaly, B.**, Arbeau, K., Palmer-Hague, J. (2025). Religiosity and the behavioral immune system. *Poster presented at SPSP in Denver, CO, USA and the Trinity Western CREATE Conference in Langley, BC.*
- Zubaly, B.**, Palmer-Hague, J. (2024). Does parental dominance influence offspring sex? *Poster presented virtually at the Northeastern Evolutionary Psychology Society Conference in Niagara Falls, NY.*
- Zubaly, B.**, Friesen, K., Fitchner, J., Venema, C., Moran-Linares, D., Arbeau, K. (2023). Disgust and religious behavior: Testing an adaptive hypothesis of religiosity. *Poster presented at the Trinity Western University CREATE Conference in Langley, BC.*
- Zubaly, B.** (2022). Why get involved in research at TWU? *Virtual talk at the Trinity Western University CREATE Conference in Langley, BC, Canada.*

MEDIA COVERAGE

- Dolan, E. (2025). Religiosity may function as a mating strategy shaped by disease avoidance psychology. *PsyPost*. <https://www.psypost.org/religiosity-may-function-as-a-mating-strategy-shaped-by-disease-avoidance-psychology/>
- Dolan, E. (2025). Fathers with more dominant-looking faces are more likely to have sons. *PsyPost*. <https://www.psypost.org/fathers-with-more-dominant-looking-faces-are-more-likely-to-have-sons/>

PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

- Zubaly, B.** (2025). Why Understanding Friendship Requires Evolutionary Psychology: Social Behavior is Fundamental to Survival and Reproduction. *Ayers Psychology and Evolution Lab Blog*. <https://www.ayerslab.org/blog/why-understanding-friendship-requires-evolutionary-psychology>

HONORS AND AWARDS

2023-2024	Scholar Athlete of the Year Award, Trinity Western University
2024	Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA), Trinity Western University

2023	American Enterprise Institute Summer Honors Program Scholar
2022	Undergraduate Student Research Award (USRA), Trinity Western University
2020-2024	Dean's List Honoree, Trinity Western University
2020-2024	U SPORTS Academic All-Canadian Award

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant 2025
 Ayers Psychology and Evolution (APE) Lab, Boise State University
 Lab Director: Jessica Ayers, Ph.D.

Research Assistant 2023-2025
 Health Psychology Lab, Trinity Western University
 Lab Director: Kelly Arbeau, Ph.D.

Research Assistant 2021-2025
 Social Neuroendocrinology Lab, Trinity Western University
 Lab Director: Jaime Palmer-Hague, Ph.D.

TEACHING

Graduate Student Instructor Spring 2026
 Department of Psychology, University of Michigan
 PSYCH 280: Introduction to Social Psychology
 Supervisor: Josh Ackerman, Professor of Psychology

Statistics Tutor Spring 2024
 Department of Athletics, Trinity Western University
 Supervisor: Sam Jung, Associate Director of Athletics

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant Fall 2023
 Department of Psychology, Trinity Western University
 PSYC 105: Introduction to Psychology
 Instructor: Todd Dutka, M.A.

Writing Tutor Fall 2021
 Writing Centre, Trinity Western University Learning Commons
 Supervisor: Emily Keery, M.A.

SERVICE

2026	EHAP Evolution in the Public Eye (EPE) Award Committee
2024-2025	Senator, Trinity Western University Student Association
2024	Reviewer, Student Research Awards, Association for Psychological Science
2024	Reviewer, Student Grant Competition, Association for Psychological Science
2023-2024	Junior Senator, Trinity Western University Student Association
2022-2023	President, Psi Chi Honor Society, Trinity Western University Chapter

2022-2023 Social Sciences Representative, Trinity Western University Student Association

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2025 Behavior Technician, Maraca Learning, Boise, ID
 2023 Proofreader, Dr. Kelly Arbeau, Associate Professor of Psychology, Langley, BC
 2021 Behavior Technician, Focused Behavior Solutions, Spokane, WA

SCHOLARSHIP AWARDS

2021-2024 President's Scholarship, Trinity Western University
 2020-2024 Spartan Athletic Scholarship, Trinity Western University
 2020-2021 Provost's Scholarship, Trinity Western University
 2020-2021 Dr. Riggs Leadership Scholarship, Salvation Army Ray and Joan Kroc Center

AFFILIATIONS

2025-Present Evolution and Human Adaptation Program, University of Michigan
 2024-Present Student Member, Cultural Evolution Society
 2024-Present Student Member, Society for Personality and Social Psychology
 2024-Present Student Member, Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science
 2023-Present Student Member, Association for Psychological Science
 2023-Present Student Member, Human Behavior and Evolution Society
 2023-2024 Student Affiliate, American Psychological Association
 2022-2024 Member, Psi Chi Honor Society, Trinity Western University Chapter

SOFTWARE COMPETENCIES

R, SPSS, Bash, Git, GitHub, SONA, WebMorph, Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC), The Lexical Suite, some Python